The Homeowner's Guide to Rodent-Proofing Your NC House

Stop Mice, Rats, and Squirrels Before They Move In



Protect your home, your health, and your peace of mind with proven rodent-proofing strategies.

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Why Rodent-Proofing Matters in North Carolina

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North Carolina's climate makes homes especially vulnerable. Our mild winters, combined with sudden cold snaps, drive mice, rats, and squirrels indoors, turning crawlspaces, attics, and basements into shelters.

Once inside, rodents cause serious problems. They chew wiring, which can spark fires, and contaminate food with droppings and urine. They also carry diseases that threaten both people and pets.

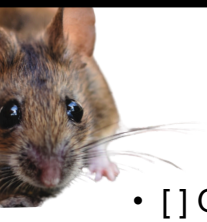
Entry is easier than most homeowners realize. A mouse can squeeze through a hole the size of a dime, and rats can gnaw through wood, plastic, and even soft concrete. Small gaps around doors, vents, or utility lines are all potential gateways. Finally, prevention is far more affordable than cleanup.

Sealing entry points and installing screens costs far less than repairing chewed wires or replacing insulation. A few proactive steps now can save thousands later.



Quick-Scan Checklist

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How Vulnerable Is Your Home?



- [ ] Gaps around doors or garage
- [ ] Crawlspace vents without screens
- [ ] Attic insulation disturbed or chewed
- [ ] Food stored in unsealed containers
- [ ] Firewood stacked against the house
- [ ] Pet food left out overnight
- [ ] No annual pest inspection booked





Common Entry Points

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Rodents are opportunists.

They exploit the smallest gaps.

- Crawlspaces: Unscreened vents, loose foundation blocks.
- Attics: Gaps near soffits, rooflines, or chimneys.
- Garages: Weatherstripping worn down, doors left open.
- Kitchens: Holes behind appliances or under sinks.
- Basements: Cracks in masonry, unsealed utility penetrations.



Pro Tip: Walk your home perimeter at dusk with a flashlight- if you see light escaping from inside, rodents see it too.



Prevention Strategies

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Rodent-proofing doesn't have to be complicated; it's about closing off the easy opportunities that mice and rats look for.

Start with the basics: seal gaps with steel wool and caulk, since rodents can't chew through steel. Add door sweeps to exterior doors so they can't slip under cracks, and screen crawlspace vents with ¼-inch hardware cloth to block entry points without restricting airflow.

Outside, keep the perimeter clear. Trim vegetation back at least three feet from the foundation so rodents don't have cover to explore, and store all food, including pet food, in airtight containers to remove temptation.

Finally, stack firewood at least 20 feet away from the house; woodpiles are prime nesting spots, and keeping them distant prevents rodents from using them as a launchpad into your home.

These simple steps, when done consistently, create a strong first line of defense that makes your house far less inviting to unwanted guests.





Seasonal Rodent Risks in North Carolina

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Rodent activity isn't the same year-round. Understanding how their behavior shifts with the seasons helps you stay one step ahead.

• **Fall:** As temperatures drop, rodents begin searching for warmth and shelter. This is prime time for infestations, as mice and rats squeeze into crawl spaces, attics, and basements before the first freeze.

• **Winter**: Once inside, rodents settle in. Crawlspaces and attics become long-term shelters, where they chew insulation, wiring, and even pipes. Because food sources are scarce outdoors, they're more likely to invade pantries and kitchens.

•**Spring:** Warmer weather triggers nesting season, and populations multiply quickly. A small problem in winter can become a full-blown infestation by spring if left unchecked.

•**Summer:** Outdoor food sources like grills, gardens, and compost bins attract rodents closer to the home. They may not move inside immediately, but they establish themselves nearby, making fall entry more likely.

Pro Tip: To stay ahead of these seasonal shifts, schedule professional inspections twice a year, in fall and spring. Fall inspections catch rodents before they move in, and spring inspections ensure nests and damage are addressed before populations explode.



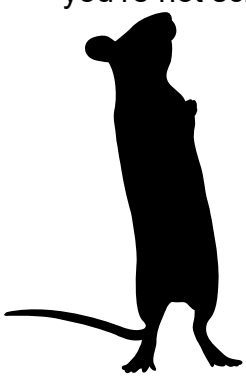


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If rodents are already inside, act quickly to limit damage:

- Identify signs — droppings, gnawed wires, scratching sounds.
- Contain food — seal pantry and pet items in airtight containers.
- Call a professional — DIY traps rarely solve larger infestations. **(Mr. Pest Control - (704) 297-5881)**
- Document damage — photos help with insurance claims.
- Plan repairs — chewed wires and insulation must be replaced for safety.

Pro Tip: Keep your pest control provider's number handy so you're not scrambling during a crisis.





Book Your Rodent-Proofing Service Today





Rodents don’t wait for the “right time” to invade; they move in the moment your home offers warmth, food, or shelter. Acting now is the smartest step you can take.

- $75 off your first inspection this month — a limited-time offer designed to make prevention affordable.

- Easy online scheduler link — visit our website and book in seconds from your phone or computer.

- Direct phone number for immediate booking — speak with a local expert who understands North Carolina homes and can answer your questions right away.

- Text-to-book option — send a quick message to our service line and confirm your appointment instantly.

- Clear warning: “Don’t wait until you hear scratching in the walls — protect your home now.”

Lincoln Plumbing’s rodent-proofing service seals entry points, secures crawlspaces, and gives you peace of mind before the next seasonal surge. A single inspection today can prevent months of frustration, costly repairs, and sleepless nights.

